

“Read the Room” Branching Scenario

1) Scenario Charter

Title: Read the Room — Even When It’s Virtual or Global

Problem Statement

In virtual and global meetings, it’s easy to **misread silence, tone, and timing**. We often lack facial expressions and body language, **group norms are unclear, hierarchy discourages honest input**, and **cultural differences** shape how people use **silence, pause time, and directness**. People frequently **assume silence equals agreement** or attach the wrong meaning to **camera-off, delayed replies, one-word chats**, and **reaction emojis**—leading to false consensus and rework. The goal is to **pause, observe, and check assumptions** so **intent and impact align**.

Audience

Global, hybrid/remote teams at any level—individual contributors, project leads, and managers collaborating across regions and seniority.

Learning Objective (what the learner will learn by the end)

- **Observe digital cues** more accurately (tone, chat cadence, reactions, camera use, pause length).
- **Ask better questions** that surface hesitation and reduce assumptions.
- **Avoid jumping to conclusions** about silence, delays, or camera-off behavior.
- **Apply emotional intelligence** (Goleman) to create psychological safety in online conversations.

Skill Focus (Goleman’s EI applied to organizational behavior)

- **Self-awareness:** Notice your own assumptions and impulse to rush.
- **Social awareness:** Decode indirect signals (tone variation, chat rhythm, emojis, camera patterns, delayed responses).
- **Relationship management / Psychological safety behaviors:** Name observations, invite challenge, amplify quieter voices, and use pulse checks.

Success Signals (observable in 1–3 weeks)

1. **Name what you’re noticing:** “I’m noticing we’re quiet—should we pause or revisit?”
2. **Amplify quieter voices:** “That point in chat is strong—would you share more?”
3. **Start with a pulse check:** “One-word check-in: how are you feeling about this plan?”

4. **Ask inclusive questions:** “What would help everyone feel confident moving forward?”

Context: Narrative & Characters

- **Meeting type:** **Mid-project global status update** for a software feature launch.
 - **Primary stake:** Launch date is **immovable**; risk of **localization testing delay** in APAC (JP).
 - **Interface:** Microsoft Teams—style (good for unmute→remute cue and reactions).
 - **Protagonist:** **Jordan** (cross-functional facilitator, mid-level).
 - **Key characters:**
 - **Alex** — Senior VP sponsor; time-pressed, wants quick alignment (raises pressure).
 - **Kenji** — APAC QA lead (Japan); thoughtful, longer pauses; may keep camera off.
 - **María** — LATAM PM; camera off at times; prefers thoughtful chat contributions.
 - **Anna** — EU Engineering; direct, structured.
 - **Priya** — Junior QA; uses chat, reactions (👏 😞 ?), hesitant to challenge aloud.
 - **Core blocker to uncover (best path):** **APAC localization testing needs +2 days** (vendor JP test env. late).
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2) Branching Structure (A/B/C)

Decision 1 — Interpret/Respond to Silence and Pace (after VP asks “Are we aligned?”)

- **A (Best):** Name the pause; run a quick round (“What would help you feel confident?”).
 - **Effect:** Lowers pressure; concerns surface; safety rises.
- **B (Partial):** “Any objections?” and move on.
 - **Effect:** Binary invite = high bar; some concerns remain hidden.
- **C (Poor):** Treat silence as agreement; finalize.
 - **Effect:** False consensus; trust dips; rework risk increases.

Decision 2 — Read Digital Signals (tone, chat, reactions, camera-off, delays)

- **A (Best):** Acknowledge a strong chat point; offer voice **or** chat; invite builds.
 - **Effect:** Multiple entry points; quieter voices engage; quality improves.
- **B (Partial):** Generic “Anyone want to add?”
 - **Effect:** Favors fast talkers; minimal change; momentum stalls.
- **C (Poor):** Voice-only; dismiss chat.
 - **Effect:** Participation narrows; low-risk channels close; trust erodes.

Decision 3 — Inclusive Check-ins & Amplification (psychological safety)

- **A (Best):** Amplify a long chat; invite the author to add a line or speak; clarify needs.
 - **Effect:** Hidden blocker revealed; collaborative plan set; timeline saved.
 - **B (Partial):** Acknowledge the chat, then move on.
 - **Effect:** Insight noted but not integrated; alignment fragile.
 - **C (Poor):** Ignore chat; wrap with “no news is good news.”
 - **Effect:** Critical risk buried; follow-up scramble; launch at risk.
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3) Linear Video Storyboard (with integrated scenario)

Characters: Jordan (facilitator/PM), Alex (time-pressed VP), Kenji (APAC QA—Japan), María (LATAM PM), Priya (junior QA), Anna (EU eng lead).

UI: Teams-like (clear unmute/remute, reactions, chat panel).

Tone: Psychologically safe, inclusive, globally accessible.

Symbols:  **BEST** |  **NEUTRAL** |  **INCORRECT**

Linear Video Storyboard (with integrated prompts)

Slide 0 — Introduction (SPARK)

Title: Read the Room — Even When It’s Virtual or Global

Purpose: Hook + set the scenario (global software launch; immovable release date).

Narration (VO):

“Ever leave a virtual meeting unsure if people agreed—or just stayed quiet? In digital rooms, **silence, tone, and chat rhythms** can hide what matters. In this project update, you’ll practice noticing signals, asking better questions, and avoiding assumptions—so your **impact matches your intent**.”

On-screen (OST): *Observe digital cues • Ask better questions • Avoid assumptions*

On-screen action: Teams grid connects; two tiles start camera-off; light reactions (👏 🤔 ?) pulse.

Navigation: Next →

DECISION 1 — Interpret/Respond to Silence & Pace

Slide 1 — Decision Point 1 (Setup + Improved Prompt)

Purpose: Present the high-stakes pause after the VP asks for alignment.

On-screen action:

- Status slide shows: “APAC QA tight—translation review pending.”
- **Alex (VP):** “Does this impact the launch? **Sound good to everyone?**”
- **Silence (3–4s);** one ‘sure’ in chat; **Kenji** unmute→remute; **María** camera-off.

Improved Prompt (to learner):

“The team’s silence could mean agreement... or hesitation. As the facilitator, how do **YOU** respond to this pause?”

Choose the response that best reflects **what you notice**, **how you build safety**, and **how to move forward**.”

Options (buttons/radio):

- **A.** Call out the quiet and invite a quick confidence check.
- **B.** Do a light check (“Any objections?”) and continue.
- **C.** Treat silence as alignment and move on.

Navigation: Select → **Submit** → routes to **Slide 1A/1B/1C**.

Slide 1A — Consequence of A (✅ BEST)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “I’m noticing we’re quiet. Quick round—**what would you need to feel confident** about the date? Chat or voice is fine.”
- **Kenji:** “We may need **two extra days** for JP localization tests.”
- **Anna:** “EU can parallelize some checks.”
- **María (chat):** “Agree—can buffer tasks shift?”

Why BEST (card): Naming the pause lowers pressure and invites dissent despite hierarchy.

OST: *Name what you’re noticing • Invite challenge*

Camera notes: Push-in on Kenji during unmute; split-screen on chat + speaker.

Navigation: Next → **Slide 1A-F (Feedback)**

Slide 1A-F — Feedback (✅ Correct)

- **Explanation (EI in feedback only):** You showed **self-awareness** (caught “silence = agreement”) and **social awareness** (treated the long pause as a cue).
- **Reflection prompt:** “Where do I assume silence means consent?”
- **Cultural insight:** In **high-context** settings (e.g., Japan), silence can signal **discomfort/indirect disagreement**.
- **Coaching card:** “Name what you’re noticing,” then ask “What would help you feel confident?”

Navigation: Continue → Decision 2

Slide 1B — Consequence of B (⚠️ NEUTRAL)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “Any objections before we lock this?”
 - A few 👍 reactions; **Kenji** stays quiet; **María** camera-off.
- Why NEUTRAL:** Binary asks **keep dissent hidden**; silence persists.
- OST:** *Don’t equate silence with agreement*
- Navigation: Next → Slide 1B-F

Slide 1B-F — Feedback (⚠️ Partial)

- **Explanation:** You “checked” but didn’t create **low-risk space**.
 - **Reflection prompt:** “How can I lower the bar for people to challenge?”
 - **Cultural insight:** **Longer pause times** can be normal; add **structure** instead of speed.
 - **Coaching card:** Try a **round-robin** or a **1-word check-in** before deciding.
- Navigation: Continue → Decision 2
-

Slide 1C — Consequence of C (❌ INCORRECT)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “Great—aligned. Next topic.”
 - **Kenji** unmute→remute; **María** types “...” then deletes.
- Why INCORRECT:** You **assumed silence = agreement**; concerns stay hidden; trust dips.

OST: *Pause • Observe • Check assumptions*

Navigation: **Next** → **Slide 1C-F**

Slide 1C-F — Feedback (✗ Incorrect)

- **Explanation:** Skipping a check **erodes psychological safety** and misses critical signals.
- **Reflection prompt:** “What one sentence can I use **before** moving on?”
- **Cultural insight:** Power + culture make public disagreement unlikely—especially with a **senior** present.
- **Coaching card:** Ask “**What are we missing?**”

Navigation: **Continue** → **Decision 2**

DECISION 2 — Read Digital Signals (tone, chat, reactions, camera-off, delays)

Slide 2 — Decision Point 2 (Setup + Improved Prompt)

On-screen action:

- Mini demo runs.
- **Priya** posts **detailed chat** on JP string wrapping.
- **Kenji** unmute→remute.
- **María** camera-off with 🙄 reaction.
- **Alex** glances at time; timeline is tight.

Improved Prompt:

“You’re noticing several digital signals at once—chat activity, reactions, delays, and unmute/remute behavior.

How will you create space so the team can share what they may be holding back?”

Choose the approach that best fits your **facilitation role**, **need for clarity**, and **reading digital cues**.

Options:

- **A.** Normalize chat/reactions; gently **invite quieter voices**.
- **B.** Generic ask: “Anyone want to add something?”
- **C.** Turn off chat; insist on **voice-only**.

Navigation: **Select** → **Submit** → **Slide 2A/2B/2C**.

Slide 2A — Consequence of A (✅ BEST)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “If it’s easier, add thoughts in chat or a quick reaction. I’d love to hear from folks we haven’t heard from yet.”
- **Priya (voice):** “Longer JP strings overflow UI—QA needs **two more days**.”
- **Kenji:** “Agree; we need vendor alignment.”
- **Anna:** “We can parallelize EU regression.”

Why BEST: You treated **chat + reactions** as valid **indirect cues** and **amplified** lower-risk channels.

OST: *Use multiple channels • Lower social risk*

Navigation: Next → Slide 2A-F

Slide 2A-F — Feedback (✅ Correct)

- **Explanation:** Strong **social awareness**—you converted digital cues into contribution.
- **Reflection prompt:** “Which **channel** (voice/chat/reactions) helps my team speak up?”
- **Cultural insight:** **Delayed replies** may reflect **translation time** or **deference**—not disinterest.
- **Coaching card:** “If chat’s easier, use it—I’ll **bring it in**.”

Navigation: Continue → Decision 3

Slide 2B — Consequence of B (⚠️ NEUTRAL)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “Anyone want to add something?”
- **Anna** speaks; others stay quiet; chat slows.

Why NEUTRAL: Generic prompts **don’t reduce pressure**; low-risk channels remain underused.

OST: *Invite builds, not just anyone*

Navigation: Next → Slide 2B-F

Slide 2B-F — Feedback (⚠️ Partial)

- **Explanation:** You noticed activity but didn't **integrate** it—insight stays **documentation**.
 - **Reflection prompt:** “How can I convert a chat point into a brief **voice invitation**?”
 - **Cultural insight:** In high-context teams, contributors may prefer **indirect** starts (chat) before speaking.
 - **Coaching card:** “**That’s important in chat—would you add a line or two?**”
- Navigation:** Continue → Decision 3
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Slide 2C — Consequence of C (✗ INCORRECT)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “Let’s keep voice-only—chat’s distracting.”
 - Long pause; **Kenji** stays silent; **Priya** stops typing.
- Why INCORRECT:** You **closed a low-risk channel**, shrinking participation and losing nuance.
- OST:** *Keep low-risk channels open*
- Navigation:** Next → Slide 2C-F

Slide 2C-F — Feedback (✗ Incorrect)

- **Explanation:** Limiting to voice ignores **valid digital cues** the lesson recommends using.
 - **Reflection prompt:** “Which **safe path** (chat/reactions) can I keep open?”
 - **Cultural insight:** Chat can be a **respectful** way to contribute when speaking up feels risky.
 - **Coaching card:** “**Use multiple channels.**”
- Navigation:** Continue → Decision 3
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DECISION 3 — Inclusive Check-ins & Amplification

Slide 3 — Decision Point 3 (Setup + Improved Prompt)

On-screen action:

- **María** posts a **long, thoughtful chat**: vendor JP test env **not ready until Thursday**; possible timeline slip.
- **Kenji** types “...” then stops.

- **Alex:** “Can we commit before I drop?”

Improved Prompt:

“Someone just shared a detailed concern in chat while others hesitate to speak. Before finalizing the plan, how do you ensure you’re not missing a critical signal?”

Options:

- **A.** Highlight the chat, invite **María** to elaborate, then run a **1-word confidence** check.
- **B.** Acknowledge the chat and move on.
- **C.** Ignore the chat and close (“No news is good news”).

Navigation: Select → **Submit** → **Slide 3A/3B/3C**.

Slide 3A — Consequence of A (✅ BEST)

Dialogue outcome (the catch):

- **Jordan:** “That’s a strong point in chat—**María**, would you share more? Then a one-word confidence check before we finalize.”
- **María (voice):** “Vendor’s JP test env is late. APAC QA needs **+2 days**.”
- **Kenji:** “We can compress review if we **lock strings today**.”
- **Pulse check (under tiles):** Anna—“Tight”; Kenji—“Depends”; María—“Cautious”; Alex—“Optimistic”; Priya—“Concerned.”
- **Jordan:** “**Decision:** Add a **+2-day APAC buffer**, lock strings today, keep global launch date.”

Why BEST: You **amplified** a quiet channel and converted it into **shared dialogue** that solved a real problem.

OST: *Turn comments into contributions • Start with a pulse check*

Navigation: Next → **Slide 3A-F**

Slide 3A-F — Feedback (✅ Correct)

- **Explanation:** Strong **relationship management**—you flattened hierarchy and built safety.
- **Reflection prompt:** “Whose **chat insight** will I bring into voice this week?”
- **Cultural insight:** A **gentle invitation** respects indirect contributions while opening space to elaborate.
- **Coaching card:** “**Amplify quieter voices**.”

Navigation: Continue → **SHIFT**

Slide 3B — Consequence of B (⚠️ NEUTRAL)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “Good point in chat—let’s note it.”
- **Anna:** “Let’s schedule a follow-up.”
- **Alex:** “I’m out—keep me posted.”

Why NEUTRAL: You noticed the signal but didn’t create **shared understanding**—alignment stays fragile.

OST: *Make it easy to speak up*

Navigation: Next → Slide 3B-F

Slide 3B-F — Feedback (⚠️ Partial)

- **Explanation:** Insight remained **not integrated** into the decision.
- **Reflection prompt:** “What **one question** would turn that chat into a plan?”
- **Cultural insight:** Brief nods can be face-saving but don’t change **power dynamics**.
- **Coaching card:** Ask: “**What would you need to feel confident?**”

Navigation: Continue → SHIFT

Slide 3C — Consequence of C (❌ INCORRECT)

Dialogue outcome:

- **Jordan:** “No news is good news—we’re locked.”
- Meeting ends; **Kenji** DMs: “We still need **+2 days**.”

Why INCORRECT: Ignoring chat **buried a critical blocker**; safety and decision quality drop.

OST: *Don’t rush the close*

Navigation: Next → Slide 3C-F

Slide 3C-F — Feedback (❌ Incorrect)

- **Explanation:** You missed **what was missing**—the real risk stayed unspoken.
- **Reflection prompt:** “What signal **did I overlook** today?”
- **Cultural insight:** In mixed-level, global calls, **indirect channels** often carry the real message.
- **Coaching card:** Run a **1-word check-in** before closing; invite the chat author to add a line.

Navigation: Continue → SHIFT

SHIFT / Reflect & STRETCH / Conclusion

Slide 4 — SHIFT (Research + Intercultural Note + Reflect)

On-screen notes (lesson-aligned):

- **Silence is ambiguous**; hierarchy & culture shape if/when people disagree.
- **Indirect cues** (tone, **chat cadence**, **reactions**) are meaningful.
- **Behavior patterns** (camera-off, **delayed replies**) have **multiple** explanations—**don't assume**.

Quick Reflection:

- “Which **digital cues** did you notice today?”
- “Where did you **jump to a conclusion**?”

Navigation: Next → STRETCH

Slide 5 — STRETCH (Conclusion & Next Steps)

Checklist (Try This at Work):

- Name what you're noticing.
- Amplify quieter voices.
- Start a 1-word check-in.
- Ask: “**What would help everyone feel confident?**”

Final VO:

“**Don't just listen for noise—listen for what's missing.** Use tone, chat cadence, and reactions as signals. Notice camera-off patterns and delayed replies—then **pause, observe, and check your assumptions.**”

Navigation: Replay Scenario | Download: Reflection & Check-in Cheat Sheet | Finish

4) Final Scenes & Takeaways

- **A-path ending (Stronger Together):** Hidden **APAC localization delay** is surfaced; team **rebalances testing** (EU parallelizes), and launch date is protected.
- **Mixed ending:** Some concerns surface but lack clarity; follow-ups needed.
- **Weak ending:** Silence misread; chat ignored; blocker discovered late; scramble ensues.

Memory line: “Don’t just listen for noise—listen for what’s missing.”

Takeaways:

- Silence is ambiguous—**don’t assume agreement**.
- Read **tone, chat cadence, reactions**.
- Notice **camera-off** and **delayed replies** without assigning intent.
- **Name what you’re noticing; invite challenge; amplify quieter voices.**

Quick “Where to Place” Notes (Rise 360)

- **After Slide 1 (Decision setup): Knowledge Check #1 (A/B/C)**
- **After Slide 2 (Decision setup): Knowledge Check #2 (A/B/C)**
- **After Slide 3 (Decision setup): Knowledge Check #3 (A/B/C)**
- **Feedback slides (A-F/B-F/C-F)** appear **immediately** after each consequence.
- **Storyline Block** (hidden or branded) mirrors each KC, sets **decisionX_choice**, updates **total_score**, and on **Slide 5** submits **Completed + Pass/Fail + Score**.

Your SCORM variables, scoring map, pass threshold, and completion trigger remain exactly as approved earlier.

5) Consequence Matrix (compact)

Decision	A — BEST (action → outcome → one-line reason)	B — NEUTRAL (action → outcome → improvement cue)	C — INCORRECT (action → outcome → reason it failed)

1. Silence & Pace	Name the pause; run quick round → Pressure drops; APAC risk emerges → Naming observations invites candid input despite hierarchy.	“Any objections?” → Most stay quiet; risk unspoken → Add structure & pause to avoid assuming silence = alignment.	Assume consent → False consensus; trust dips → You treated silence as agreement ; missed the moment to check assumptions.
2. Digital Signals	Amplify chat; offer voice/chat; invite builds → Multiple entry points; ideas surface → Chat + reactions are valid indirect cues ; lower social risk.	Generic “Anyone else?” → Favors fast talkers; momentum stalls → Convert chat to dialogue with a specific invite.	Voice-only; dismiss chat → Participation narrows; safety drops → You closed a low-risk channel and lost nuance.
3. Amplification	Elevate long chat; invite to share more → Blocker revealed; plan adjusted → You turned comments into contributions and flattened hierarchy.	Mention chat; move on → Insight noted, not integrated → Ask one inclusive question to make it actionable.	Ignore chat; close → Critical risk buried; rework risk high → You missed what was missing ; no inclusive check-in.

6) SCORM Variables + Scoring Logic

Variables

- `decision1_choice` (string: A/B/C)
- `decision2_choice` (string: A/B/C)
- `decision3_choice` (string: A/B/C)
- `total_score` (integer 0–30)

Scoring

- **A = 10, B = 5, C = 0**
- **Passing: 20/30**
- **Completion trigger:** Learner reaches the **STRETCH / Conclusion** slide.

Plain-English Logic

After each decision's Knowledge Check, set **decisionX_choice** to the selected letter and add points to **total_score** per the map. On the **Final** slide, evaluate:

- If **total_score** ≥ 20 → set status **Passed** and **Completed**; report raw score.
- Else → set status **Failed** and **Completed**; report raw score.

JSON-like reference (for LMS/engineers)

JSON

```
{
```

```
"variables": {
```

```
"decision1_choice": {"type": "string", "enum": ["A","B","C"]},
```

```
"decision2_choice": {"type": "string", "enum": ["A","B","C"]},
```

```
"decision3_choice": {"type": "string", "enum": ["A","B","C"]},
```

```
"total_score": {"type": "integer", "min": 0, "max": 30, "default": 0}
```

```
},
```

```
"scoring_map": {"A": 10, "B": 5, "C": 0},
```

```
"pass_threshold": 20,
```

```
"completion_trigger": "final_scene_viewed",
```

```
"reporting": {
```

```
"scorm_version": "SCORM 2004",
```

```
"send_cmi_core_score": true,
```

```
"send_cmi_interactions": true,
```

```
"score_range": [0, 30]
```

```
}
```

```
}
```

Show more lines

Implementation note (Rise 360 + Storyline Block)

Rise **Knowledge Checks** capture the user's visible choices, but a **Storyline Block** should store the variables, compute **total_score**, and send **completion + pass/fail** to the LMS. Place one Storyline Block after each decision to set **decisionX_choice** and update **total_score**, plus a final Storyline Block on the STRETCH slide to submit results.

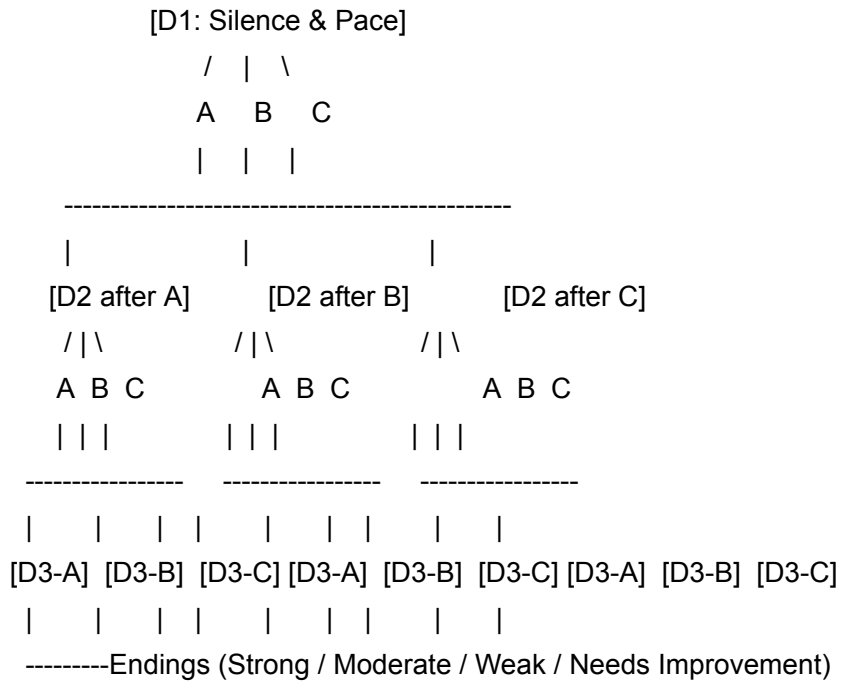
7) Developer Notes for Rise 360

Recommended block stack (per section)

- **SPARK (Intro):** Text block (title + subtitle) → **Video block** (intro scene).
- **Decision 1:** Video (scene) → **Knowledge Check (Single Select A/B/C)** → **Storyline Block** (setBelow is your **complete SCORM-ready VIDEO STORYBOARD package for Rise 360**, rewritten with a **stronger narrative** (mid-project status update; Teams-style UI; immovable launch; APAC localization blocker) and aligned strictly to the lesson **“Read the Room — Even When It’s Virtual or Global.”**

Citations point to the uploaded lesson.

Full Tree in Compressed Visual Form



Visual:

Branching Scenario

